

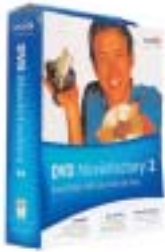
Ulead DVD MovieFactory 2

Burns DVDs, not pockets

This product is primarily targeted at the home user. It uses a wizard-based interface to make movies. Although an excellent feature for novices, more experienced users might find it tedious.

Creating a movie is simple—just start a new project with the wizard, choose any of the three formats (DVD, VCD or SVCD), and you're all set! The Direct to Disc option in the wizard uses the DV-In DVD-Out capability; you can record from a camcorder directly onto the CD or DVD without storing on the hard disk—though, without a wireless camcorder you will be limited to the length of the connecting wire

Price: Rs 2,800
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to your PC or laptop. It supports the Windows QuickTime MOV format, amongst others and the Photo Express bundle is an advantage, as one does not need additional tools to burn CD or DVD labels. At a price of about Rs 3,000, this is one of the cheapest products in this category. Ulead DVD MovieFactory 2 makes movie making fun and easy and is recommended for novices.

SPECIFICATIONS

Box Contents: Ulead Photo Express 4.0, My Custom Edition Plus, DirectX 8, Windows Media Player, Apple QuickTime, and Adobe Acrobat Reader

Ulead DVD MovieFactory 2		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

MSI 650GLM COMBO

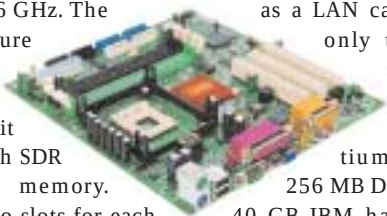
All-aboard Integration

The MSI 650GLM Combo motherboard is built on a Micro-ATX board that fits easily into your computer cabinet. The board has a 478-pin socket for Pentium 4 processors, and a 400 MHz front side bus (FSB) that supports processors up to 2.6 GHz. The special feature of this motherboard is that it supports both SDR and DDR memory. There are two slots for each type allowing for a maximum of 2 GB of memory.

It has two USB ports and an additional USB header, where extra USB devices can be connected via the extension. As the board is small,

there are only three PCI slots and no AGP slot—you have to settle for the onboard SiS 650 graphics chipset. The BIOS is hardwired and will be difficult to replace in case of a malfunction. The absence of an onboard LAN is also notable, as a LAN card will leave only two free PCI slots.

We used a Pentium 4 2.2 GHz, 256 MB DDR SDRAM, a 40 GB IBM hard disk on a 17-inch monitor to test this board. It performed adequately in the PC Mark 2002 and 3DMark 2001 tests, with some tests being skipped due to lack of hardware support. When running *Quake III*



Arena, it clocked 70.1 fps in normal mode and 28.3 fps in high quality. This fps score is just enough for casual gamers, though not enough for networked gaming. We couldn't run Content Creation 2003—it crashed every time we ran it—and SiSoft Sandra indicated that the board is sufficient for word processing and Web browsing.

Price: Rs 2,800
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SPECIFICATIONS

Micro-ATX, 400 MHz Front Side Bus, 478-pin socket for Pentium 4, supports 1.7 GHz to 2.6 GHz speeds, SiS 650GL and SiS 962L MuTIOL Media I/O chipsets, supports both DDR and SDR SDRAM (maximum 2 GB), 3x PCI slots, 2x USB 2.0 ports

MSI 650GLM COMBO		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Che-ez Spyz Digital Camera

Say che-ez

Spyz is slightly larger than a matchbox and comes in silver and metallic blue. It bundles a dog tag and an USB cable, but oddly, misses the battery. The software bundle comprises the Che-ez manager, Arcsoft Photo Studio 2000 and the driver CD.

The manual explains features such as sound beeps, LED and LCD displays very neatly. The device can take up to 26 photos in the high-resolution mode of 640 x 480 pixels, and 107 photos in the low resolution mode of 320 x 240 pixels. Other features include a timer and continuous capture that turns the camera into a camcorder. The Che-ez Manager also lets you convert frames into a movie in AVI format.

The Spyz can also act as a Web camera when used with the Che-ez Manager or MS Netmeeting. However, sometimes the manager does not recognise shortcut keys such as the [Alt] + [F4] combination for closing the program. The interface is also very basic and

Price: Rs 4,995
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below par.

The price tag may justify all the features of the Spyz, but the management software has too many drawbacks to ignore. Also, there is no provision for an additional memory card. Although Spyz is difficult to compare with the other cameras in the market, it's a better bet than any other camera offering this resolution.

SPECIFICATIONS

0.35 megapixel, CMOS sensor, video clip duration 8 sec (high) and 28 sec (low); 8 MB SDRAM; BMP storage format, Lens: 2.8 mm, 6.2 mm; Automatic exposure and white balance; USB interface; Dimensions: 60 x 38.6 x 15 mm; Weight: 34 gms

Che-ez Spyz Digital Camera		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	